

SORRAVICH KINGSUWANKUL

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ABOUT ME

I am a behavioral and experimental economist, working on topics related to organizational economics, labor economics and political economy. My primary research interests are in dishonesty, norms, and unethical behavior in markets and organizations. My work examines how individuals make decisions in socially and economically relevant contexts and identifies psychological factors that shape their behavior and beliefs. Using experimental methods, I isolate behavioral mechanisms that drive economic decisions, which is essential for understanding and addressing important societal challenges.

POSITIONS AND AFFILIATIONS

Postdoctoral researcher , SBE, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam	Nov. 2022 - Present
Candidate fellow , Tinbergen Institute	Feb. 2023 - Present

ACADEMIC QUALIFICATION

Qualification , Maître de conférences, Section 5 - Sciences économiques	2026
PhD in Economics , Université Lumière Lyon 2 & GATE-CNRS, France Title: Essays on the Behavioral Economics of Dishonesty Supervisor: Marie Claire Villeval Jury: Brice Corgnet, Lata Gangadharan, Nicolas Jacquemet, Vanessa Valero	Oct. 2018 - Sep. 2022
Master in Economics , Thammasat University, Thailand	Aug. 2014 - Aug. 2016
Bachelor of Arts (Hons.) in Economics , University of Delhi, India	Aug. 2009 - Aug. 2012

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Online course on z-Tree, University of Konstanz	2021
Online course on Experimetrics, University of East Anglia	2021
Winter School on Credence Goods, Incentives and Behavior, University of Innsbruck	2022
Online course on oTree, University of Oxford	2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Behavioral economics, Experimental economics, Microeconomics.
Information asymmetry, Belief formations, Strategic behavior, Communication, Honesty, Norms, Gender.

JOB MARKET PAPER

Strategic incompetence and gender stereotypes, co-authored with Christina Rott and Janneke Oostrom

The paper examines how individuals strategically claim incompetence to avoid costly public goods tasks, such as non-promotable tasks. Using a laboratory experiment, we exogenously vary the gender stereotype associated with a task to study its impact on communicated ability and task assignment. We find that individuals consistently claim incompetence and successfully evade assignment. When tasks are stereotyped, gender gaps in communicated ability emerge in stereotype-consistent directions. These gaps are not driven by gender differences in strategic incompetence, but by self-stereotyping: when stereotypes become salient, individuals lower their private self-assessments if their gender is viewed as less competent. Our results underscore the importance of stereotype salience and highlight how communication of incompetence in strategic situations can perpetuate gender disparities by reinforcing unequal task assignment. My contributions are conceptualization, design, programming, data collection, analysis and writing the first draft.

PUBLICATIONS

Are mandatory oaths effective in groups? *Experimental Economics*, 2025, 28(2), 317–333. (single-authored).

This paper examines whether honesty oaths remain effective in group settings, where dishonest behavior is typically more prevalent. Using a laboratory experiment, I show that the effectiveness of oaths depends on incentive structures and implementation procedures. Mandatory oaths reduce lying when payoffs are independent but have limited effects under payoff interdependence, whereas voluntary oaths enhance truth-telling across both environments by fostering intrinsic motivation. The results highlight the role of peer effects and their interaction with institutional design in shaping ethical behavior in groups.

WORKING PAPERS

Promise-Keeping and the Internal Judge, co-authored with Chloe Tergiman and Marie Claire Villeval. *Under review, Econometrica*.

This paper studies why people keep promises to tell the truth. Using a strategic communication game, we show that honesty oaths substantially reduce lying by internalizing an “audience”, even when monitoring is absent. When individuals do lie, they avoid blatant, detectable lies and instead resort to ambiguity, a pattern that persists even when compliance is unobservable. These findings challenge standard reputational models and suggest that oath-takers answer to an internal judge rather than an external monitor. We further show that receivers anticipate this mechanism and adjust their beliefs accordingly. My contributions are conceptualization, design, programming, data collection, analysis and writing the first draft.

Do individuals take more risk with unethically earned money?, co-authored with Marie Claire Villeval. *Preparing for submission*.

This paper studies whether dishonestly earned money is treated as a windfall gain or as the result of costly effort. In an online experiment, we show that individuals take more risk with dishonest earnings, treating them similarly to windfall gains, especially among risk-averse liars. Increasing the moral cost of lying ex post eliminates this difference, suggesting that moral costs can induce an entitlement effect in economic decision-making. My contributions are conceptualization, design, programming, data collection, analysis and writing the first draft.

BOOK CHAPTER

Experiments on labor market discrimination, joint with Ernesto Reuben and Christina Rott, in Handbook of Gender and Experimental Economics, *Edward Elgar*, *forthcoming*.

This book chapter provides a structured overview of the experimental literature on gender discrimination in labor markets. We organize the literature along two dimensions: diversity (hiring, promotion, and occupational segregation) and inclusion (treatment within organizations, including evaluations and workplace interactions). The chapter highlights how experimental methods identify causal mechanisms underlying discrimination and outlines promising directions for future research. My contribution focuses on synthesizing the literature and writing the first draft.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Collaborative Science

Comparing Human-Only, AI-Assisted, and AI-Led Teams on Assessing Research Reproducibility in Quantitative Social Science, Brodeur et al. (2025). **Accepted, PNAS**.

I contributed to this large-scale collaborative project (288 researchers, 103 teams) assessing reproducibility in social science. Human-only and AI-assisted teams outperformed AI-led approaches in error detection and robustness checks.

A Comment on “The Gender Gap in Self-Promotion” by Exley and Kessler (2022), joint with Diogo Geraldese, Aidas Masiliunas, Christina Rott and Christoph Siemroth, Unpublished.

Part of a large-scale collaborative project evaluating reproducibility of economics publications. I contributed to data analysis, robustness checks and writing the comment as part of a multi-author team. We have finalized our part and the paper is being written by the main authors (Brodeur et al.).

Pre-PhD Publications

Friends and exam cheating: an experimental study in Thailand, *Kasetsart Journal of Social Science*, 2020, 41(2), 250-255. Pre-PhD, co-authored with Tanapong Potipiti.

This paper studies peer effects in cheating in a lab setting. We find no effects in overstatement, but positive peer effects in copying; when both cheating options are available, individuals mainly choose to overstate.

Sabotage and deterrence incentive in tournament, *Thammasat Review of Economic and Social Policy*, 2017, 3(1), 24-66. Pre-PhD.

This paper studies the impact of deterrence incentive in dissuading sabotage in rank-order tournaments using a lab experiment. I find that punishment reduces sabotage, with probabilistic monitoring more effective than penalty severity.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Military conscription and the persistence of gender norms, joint with Diego Marino Fages - *Design stage*

This project studies the impact of (obligatory) military conscription on gender norms and intergenerational expectations. Exploiting a draft lottery in Thailand, we examine whether exposure to conscription shapes norms and whether correcting misperceived social beliefs can promote more egalitarian choices.

Masculinity norms and parental leave penalties, joint with Christina Rott - *Conceptualization stage*

This project examines how male breadwinner norms shape parental leave decisions. We study how social expectations about gender roles affect leave-taking decisions and whether correcting misperceived norms can influence labor market choices of parents.

Power and cheating, joint with Chloe Tergiman and Marie Claire Villeval - *Conceptualization stage*
This project investigates the causal relationship between power and dishonest behavior. Using laboratory experiments, we aim to disentangle the effect of holding power from the self-selection of individuals into positions of authority.

SCIENTIFIC COMMUNICATION

I regularly attend and present my research at international conferences, workshops, and seminars. The complete list of my presentations is below (* indicates scheduled).

EASP General Meeting, Strasbourg*; ASFEE Conference, Lille*; ESA African Meeting, Rabat*; 2026
Tinbergen Institute Science For Society Conference, Amsterdam*; COPE, Rotterdam; GATE-Lab seminar, Lyon; ADRES Conference, Paris.

ASFEE Graduate Meeting, Aussois; University of Portsmouth's Economic seminar (invited & on- 2025
line); Matterhorn Symposium, Brig; ESA European Meeting, Brno; TIBER Symposium, Tilburg;
PIER Research Workshop, Bank of Thailand; ASFEE Conference, Nancy; IMEBESS, Valencia.

ESA European Meeting, Helsinki; MCV Workshop, University Carlos III, Madrid. 2024

EEA, Barcelona; TIBER Symposium, Tilburg; ESA World Meeting, Lyon; M-BEES, Maastricht; 2023
ASFEE Conference, Montpellier

ESA European Meeting, Bologna; Winter School on Credence Goods, Incentives and Behavior, 2022
University of Innsbruck; ASFEE Conference, Lyon.

ASFEE Conference, Dijon; TIBER Symposium, Tilburg; Lyon-Maastricht Behavioral Economics 2021
Workshop (online); ESA World Meeting (online)

FUNDING & SCHOLARSHIP

Research funding, M&O Dept., SBE VU Amsterdam (3,000 Euros) 2024

Research funding, GATE-Lab (2,500 Euros) 2021

Research funding, PIER, Bank of Thailand (150,000 Thai Baht) 2020

Doctoral contract, Université Lumière Lyon 2 2018 - 2021

Master's scholarship with stipend, Bank of Thailand 2015 - 2016

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

Organizational Theory (Tutorials, Bachelor, 21 hours) Fall 2022 & 2023

Research Methods in Business Administration (Tutorials, Master, 26 hours) Spring 2023 & 2024

Master's thesis supervision (6 students) 2022-2024

REFEREEING

Industrial and Labor Relations Review, Journal of Economic Science Association, Economic Inquiry,
Regulation and Governance

OTHER SERVICES TO THE PROFESSION

Organizing team, 1st Gender and Diversity Roundtable, VU Amsterdam 2023

Organizing team, 25th Colloquium on Personnel Economics (COPE), VU Amsterdam 2023

Organizing team, 12th French Association of Experimental Economics (ASFEE), Lyon 2022

Organizer of the PhD students working group, GATE-Lab 2020 - 2021

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research assistant, Marie Claire Villeval, GATE-Lab	Sep. 2021 - Dec. 2021
Member of CORTEX Laboratory of Excellence	Oct. 2018 - Sep. 2022
Research assistant, CBEE, Chulalongkorn University	2016 - 2018
Editorial assistant, TRESP, Thammasat University	2015 - 2018
Private tutor	2013 - 2018

SKILLS

Language	English (<i>fluent</i>), French (<i>DALF C1</i>), Thai (<i>mother tongue</i>)
Computer	STATA, z-Tree, oTree, PHP, SQL, SPSS, LaTeX, MS Office

REFERENCES

Marie Claire Villeval	Emeritus Research Professor, GATE, CNRS–Université de Lyon villeval@gate.cnrs.fr
Christina Rott	Associate Professor, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam c.e.rott@vu.nl
Chloe Tergiman	Associate Professor, Pennsylvania State University cjt16@psu.edu

Analytical Presentation of my research, teaching, and administrative activities

Sorravich Kingsuwankul

RESEARCH

Research Philosophy

My research aims to identify causal mechanisms underlying economic phenomena because this understanding is key for effective policy design to target the correct behavioral drivers. I view experimental methods as a powerful tool to disentangle the drivers of individual decisions, particularly when observational data cannot separate competing explanations.

I prioritize simple study designs that capture key features of real-world settings to facilitate clear interpretation. I also believe that experimental research can be complemented by survey and observational data to enhance external validity.

More broadly, I view economic behavior as shaped not only by material incentives but also by intrinsic motivations and social constraints. My approach is theoretically grounded and emphasizes transparency, reproducibility, and scientific integrity.

Research domains

My research examines how incentives, norms, and beliefs shape economic behavior in markets and organizations. I aim to understand behavioral mechanisms underlying phenomena, such as honesty, workplace inequality, and labor market outcomes. Using lab and online experiments, I identify psychological factors that drive economic decisions, and study how institutions and social environments amplify or constrain behavior.

Strategic Communication and Task Inequality

In my [job market paper](#) (joint with Christina Rott and Janneke Oostrom), we study how individuals claim incompetence to avoid costly public goods tasks. These tasks are essential for the organization, but they are non-promotable. We find that individuals engage in strategic incompetence, but when tasks are stereotyped, gender gaps in communicated ability arise from by self-stereotyping: individuals adjust their private self-assessments to match the stereotype where their gender is believed to be ‘incompetent’. This mechanism helps explain why women disproportionately shoulder non-promotable tasks, reinforcing gender inequalities in the workplace. To enhance external validity, we are designing a field survey to elicit stereotyped beliefs about such tasks outside the laboratory. We aim to submit the paper to general-interest journals such as AER, QJE, RESTUD, JEEA and Management Science.

The paper opens avenues for future research. One direction is to study belief formation by examining how motivated reasoning and biased updating sustain self-stereotyping, and thus incompetence claims. Another focuses on the demand side: how do managers interpret and respond to incompetence claims, and whether these responses amplify or mitigate gender inequality in task allocation. Lastly, while we focus on gender, the mechanism could extend to other stereotypes (e.g., age or ethnicity) and intersectional contexts.

In this domain, I have contributed a [book chapter](#) on gender discrimination in labor markets (with Ernesto Reuben and Christina Rott, forthcoming in Handbook of Gender and Experimental Economics, Edward Elgar), synthesizing experimental evidence on hiring, promotion, and workplace interactions.

Understanding and Reducing Dishonest Behavior

My research in this domain examines the mechanisms that sustain or reduce dishonest behavior, and their economic consequences. Oaths are one example of such commitment mechanisms, widely used in several domains such as the financial and medical sectors and even in the political sphere. My [work](#) (joint with Chloe Tergiman and Marie Claire Villeval) shows that honesty oaths operate through an internalized constraint rather than external monitoring: individuals avoid producing verifiable evidence of dishonest actions. This challenges standard reputational models and highlights the role of internal moral constraints in promise-keeping.

In the [single-authored work](#), published in *Experimental Economics*, I show that oaths remain effective in groups, but their impact depends on incentive and implementation. My work highlights the role of peer effects on the effectiveness of oaths in group settings where social interactions are inherent.

I also examine the economic consequences of dishonest behavior in a joint [work](#) with Marie Claire Villeval. We show that individuals take more risk with dishonest earnings, treating them as windfall gains, particularly among risk-averse individuals. Increasing the moral cost of lying eliminates this effect, suggesting that moral costs can generate an entitlement effect in decision-making.

A natural extension of this research agenda is to examine whether the impact of oaths depends on norms or perceived honesty levels; if the impact of oaths is partially driven by social norms, their effectiveness may decrease when norms are eroded. This line of research can be explored in both individual and group settings. Another direction is to shift the focus from oath-takers to those who interact with them, as oaths play a key role in sustaining trust in economic and social exchange. This has important implications when oaths are commonly used to enhance public trust.

Work in progress

I am currently developing several projects that extend my research agenda on norms, beliefs, and unethical behavior across different economic environments.

One project examines how institutions contribute to the formation and persistence of gender norms. Exploiting the quasi-random assignment of the draft lottery in Thailand, I examine whether military conscription influences beliefs about gender roles in the labor market and intergenerational expectations of how boys and girls ought to be. I also investigate whether correcting misperceived social norms can promote more egalitarian choices in child investment, linking institutional exposure to norm formation and human capital outcomes.

Another project examines how masculinity norms shape labor supply decisions within households. Focusing on parental leave intentions, I investigate how traditional breadwinner norms, which prescribe men to paid work and women to caregiving, shape parents' labor market participation. I examine whether individuals misperceive prevailing expectations about fathers' and mothers' roles, and whether these misperceptions in turn constrain labor supply. By providing information about these norms, the project evaluates whether correcting misperceptions can shift parental leave intentions, highlighting on how norms sustain gender inequalities in the labor market.

A third project examines the relationship between power and dishonest behavior. I aim to disentangle whether holding power causally affects unethical behavior, or whether individuals prone to misbehave self-select into positions of authority. Using lab experiments, this project isolates the causal effect of power from selection and contributes to understanding how organizational hierarchies shape ethical conduct.

Research Perspective

My research agenda is guided by a central objective: to understand how incentives, norms, and beliefs interact to shape economic behavior, and how these mechanisms can be leveraged to address real-world economic problems. While my current work focuses on organizational and labor market settings, the behavioral mechanisms I study are broadly applicable across fields; notably, domains where social preferences and collective action are important such as issues related to environmental sustainability and public health.

I view experimental methods as a powerful tool not only to test economic theory, but also to generate new insights into how individuals make decisions in strategic and social environments. My approach serves as a natural complement to theoretical approaches, allowing us to test model predictions against data from controlled environments. In combination with survey and observational data, and field settings, external validity and policy relevance can be enhanced.

I am committed to integrate into the laboratory and actively contribute to its academic life (seminars, workshops, and outreach activities), and develop research collaborations there.

TEACHING

Teaching Philosophy

I adopt a student-centered approach that emphasizes active learning and critical thinking. I design classes around real-world applications and incorporate hands-on exercises. For example, I use classroom experiments to allow students to experience first-hand how theoretical concepts translate (or sometimes fail to translate) into actual decisions. This encourages discussion, analytical thinking, and practical application of economic ideas. I aim to create an inclusive and interactive learning environment while maintaining high academic standards.

Teaching Fields

I would be comfortable in teaching the following courses:

Undergraduate: Microeconomics, Probability and Statistics, (Applied) Econometrics and Data Analysis.

Graduate: Behavioral Economics, Experimental Economics, Game Theory, Programming for Economic Experiments, Experimetrics, Morals in Markets and Organizations.

I can also teach specialized courses based on my research expertise, including gender in the labor market, discrimination in diversity and inclusion, and economic psychology.

Teaching Experience

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam (2022–2024)

- Tutorials in English, *Organizational Theory* (Bachelor, International Business Administration)
- Tutorials in English, *Research Methods in Business Administration* (Master, Quantitative Track)
- Supervision of 6 MSc theses (design, data collection, and empirical analysis)

Teaching Load

Course	Programme	Year	Hours
Organizational Theory	BA IBA	2022	21
Research Methods	MSc BA (Quant)	2023	26
Organizational Theory	BA IBA	2023	21
Research Methods	MSc BA (Quant)	2024	26
Thesis supervision	MSc BA	2023–2024	6 students

Additional Experience

Freelance private tutor in English and Maths (2013–2018), teaching high school students.

SERVICES

I actively contribute to the academic community through refereeing, event organization, and support for research infrastructure. I have served as a referee for journals including *Industrial and Labor Relations Review*, *Journal of the Economic Science Association*, *Economic Inquiry*, and *Regulation and Governance*. I have also helped organize several academic events, including the 1st Gender and Diversity Roundtable and the 25th Colloquium on Personnel Economics (COPE) at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, as well as the 12th conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics (ASFEE) in Lyon. In addition, I organized a PhD students' working group at GATE-Lab, fostering regular research discussions and collaboration among PhD students.

During my postdoctoral position at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, I have contributed to the development and maintenance of experimental infrastructure of the School of Business and Economics – VU Behavioral Lab. I collaborated with the lab manager and the technician to set up z-Tree, and co-write a z-Tree manual with Florian Heine to support researchers setting up their experiments using z-Tree. Within my axis (Human resource and Organizational Behavior) at the Management and Organizational department, I have also promoted a culture of sharing work-in-progress by encouraging PhD students and postdocs to present their projects, fostering constructive feedback and early-stage collaboration.

Updated: March 2026